VOL 116 #1 JANUARY - FEBRUARY 2011

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http://www.virtualstampclub.com/apstexas.html

The PHILATEX

A.P.S. Ch. # 53-0388

T.P.A. Life Ch. # 3

MEETING CALENDAR

JANUARY			FEBRUARY		
7	Juniors Board of Governors meeting Meeting & Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm	4	Juniors Board of Governors meeting Meeting & Program: "Show & Tell"	6:15 pm 7:00 pm 7:30 pm
14	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm	11	Auction - Come at 7 to browse (set-up at 6:30 - no lots after 7:10)	7:30 pm
21	Juniors Program: "Chocolate!!!" By Nelda Greer	6:15 pm 7:30 pm	18	Juniors Program: "Vanilla" by Dr. Eric Shephard	6:15 pm 7:30 pm
28	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm	19	Sat. Boursette & Library Day -- Buy, sell, trade, and talk stamps ;-)	9:00 am
29	Sat. Boursette & Library Day -- Buy, sell, trade, and talk stamps ;-)	9:00 am	25	Bourse – buy, sell and trade (set-up at 6:30 pm)	7:00 pm
17	Martin Luther King Day		14	HAPPY VALENTINE'S DAY	♥♥♥

3/04 - Jrs, BOG&G, Show&Tell : 3/05 - Sat.Boursette : 3/11 - Auction : 3/18 - Jrs, Program : 3/25 - Bourse

Martin Luther King - Jan 17 (Scott #1771)

Valentine's Day - Feb 14 (Scott #4122)

Editors' Corner

To all our friends we wish a Happy and Prosperous New Year.

If there is no Membership Card stapled to this page, you need to read the Membership Information on page 3. We hope that all of our members will remain with us in the coming year.

If you didn't get to come to the Christmas Party, you missed a delicious feast, and a fun time. The food was yummy and plentiful. Dora's Mac salad recipe is on page 3, and Dr. Eric Shepherd's delightful Cheesy Potato Casserole was made from an Ore-Ida recipe that can be found at http://www.oreida.com/recipes/cheesy-potato-casserole . The turkey was from the Barbecue Station, and there were many palate pleasing side dishes and desserts.

Pat Richmond gave everyone a memory booklet of photos from last year's Christmas party, and then challenged us to figure out who was in the very close-up photos of people taken from that booklet. She also provided the prizes—4 adorable ceramic snowmen figurines. The competition was fierce, and full of laughter as people tried to figure out who was which! Jack Virta got all of them correct, and his wife Carolyn carefully picked out his prize for him(p.6). Bob Joyce was next, with only one wrong, and Lea Senghaas (yours truly) missed only two. The final snowman was drawn as a doorprize by Rich Barnes. There were also two small Christmas trees with real flashing lights and mini-ornaments, made by Lea Senghaas (me again). The happy winners were Chip Swinney and Vernon Duncan.

We hope to see all of you in the coming year.

Lea Senghaas and Dora Roberts

PHILATEX: Editors Lea Senghaas & Dora Roberts
Labels Fred Groth
Mailing Jack Virta & Richard Spies

The PHILATEX is published every two months and the cut off date is the 2nd Friday of the month prior to publication.

Mail your contributions for the Philatex to:
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Or email either of us.
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Write to S.A.P.A. at:
San Antonio Philatelic Association
MacArthur Park Lutheran Church
2903 Nacogdoches Rd.
San Antonio, TX 78217

S.A.P.A. meets at the church every Friday night at 7:30 P.M. in building 1.

ELECTED OFFICERS:

President:	John Clay
Vice President:	Nelda Greer
Secretary:	Pat Richmond
Treasurer:	Fred Groth
Membership Chairman:	Dora Roberts
Communications Chairman:	Judy Grant
Historian:	Fred Groth
Auctioneer:	Jack Virta
Assistant Auctioneer:	John Clay
Librarian:	Richard Rose

BOARD OF GOVERNORS:

Board President:	John Clay
All Elected Officers:	(see above)
Past President:	Jane K Fohn
One year term:	Charles Shelby
Two year term:	Skip Swinney
Parliamentarian:	Bob Joyce
Honorary Board Member	Richard Spies

APPOINTED:

Auditing Committee:	Tony Bir (Chairman)

LIAISON CONTACT PERSONS:

American Philatelic Society:	Fred Groth
Austin-Texas Stamp Club:	Lyle Boardman
Eire Philatelic Association:	Patrick J. Ryan
Texas Philatelic Association:	Robert J. Joyce
APS Circuit Books	John Clay

WE WELCOME VISITORS

SAPA is always happy to welcome visitors. We hope you will enjoy our activities, and wish to join us as members.

All visitors are welcome to purchase stamps at our auctions, bourse, and bag nights. Anyone wishing to sell or trade at our meetings must be a member.

AUCTION ETIQUETTE :

Be sure to get your Bidder's number card before the auction starts. Come early and look over the lots for sale before the auction. During the auction, lots will be identified by their lot number and a brief description of the lot.

When bidding for a lot, please raise your Bidder's Number card and keep it up until you no longer wish to bid. Flipping the card up and down is confusing for the auctioneers.

Please keep extraneous conversation to a minimum. This makes it easier for everyone to hear what the auctioneer is selling, and allows the auctioneer to more easily keep track of the bidding.

Please wait until the end of the auction to pay for your purchases. Your name will be called as the tallys are completed. Those who are only buying will be called first. Buyers who are also sellers will be called next. Checks are acceptable, made out to S.A.P.A.

Sellers with unsold lots should be sure to pick up their lots before leaving.

Please be sure to return the Bidder's Number cards so that we can use them again in the following auctions.

We look forward to meeting you.

PRESIDENT'S MESSAGE

Hi to all,

I trust that everyone had a wonderful holiday season. Now that you all are overweight, it will take until Easter to remove all that extra stuff. But it sure was good wasn't it?

Speaking of something good, my one year term of office is up. It was a blast. Thanks to everyone. We had a good year with plenty of stamps changing hands through our Bourses and the Saturday "Boursettes" and our Auctions. Thanks to Jack's hard work all of us were able to inflate our collections.

The programs during the year were really informative. A lot of info was put out there for the members to observe. We welcome all the new members of the year, and we say goodbye to those who have passed, have met their calling and left good old mother earth for a more peaceful afterlife.

Thanks again….

* * *

The new President now speaking. Hi!

I'm back for another chance to do better. I am looking forward to another year of working with all of you. If anyone of you has any ideas on how to get things working better, please let me know. I will always be open to new thoughts and ideas.

Let's have a good year.

Thanks to all of you. *John Clay*

MEMBERSHIP INFORMATION

Those of you who have paid your dues for 2011 prior to the mailing of the Philatex will find their membership cards on the first page of this newsletter. If you didn't get your card, you still have a chance to pay your dues, but as of January 1, 2011, the cost will be $15. Anyone who hasn't paid by January 31st will be dropped from the membership roster, and will receive no further reminders, or Philatexes. You will also lose the privilege of selling at our auctions and bourses, but will continue to be welcome as visitors. If you have questions, speak to me at meetings or write to me at 12204 Ridge Crown, S.A., TX 78247.

Dora Roberts, SAPA Membership Chair

Dora's Macaroni Salad:

A tub of HEB brand macaroni salad (from the deli already made)
A can of dark red kidney beans
A can of green peas
Chopped sweet onions
Chopped celery
Chopped ham, chicken, tuna or turkey, optional

There are no exact quantities because it all depends on how much you want to make. Just mix all together until it looks good for you. I drain the canned veggies and rinse them just to get all juices off. After you put it in the serving dish of your choice, chill until ready to serve. Just before serving, you can, if you wish, crush cracker crumbs and sprinkle over the top. Yum, yum. Enjoy.

Program Notes Jan 21 - "Chocolate" by Nelda Greer Nelda tells me that she is going to tantalize us with the study of cacao. She will share with us some of the stamps and covers that illustrate the history, cultivation, production and distribution of cacao.

Of course, there will be some "samples" of the real stuff so we can enjoy some of the many different forms of this favorite food.

As usual, Nelda has put her own "spin" on philately. The night should be fun as well as educational.

Program Notes Feb 18 - "Vanilla" by Dr. Eric Shephard No matter what the subject, place or notable person, you can probably find a stamp somewhere in the world that shows it. As an example, Dr. Eric Shephard will present a talk on the history of the vanilla orchid and its depiction on stamps from various countries around the world.

Last month we had Chocolate, this month Vanilla—does someone collect strawberries and bananas on stamps? If so, we could have banana splits.

Oh, well, I for one am interested in knowing about vanilla orchids. We are all looking forward to your program, Eric.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond

UPCOMING SHOWS & BOURSES

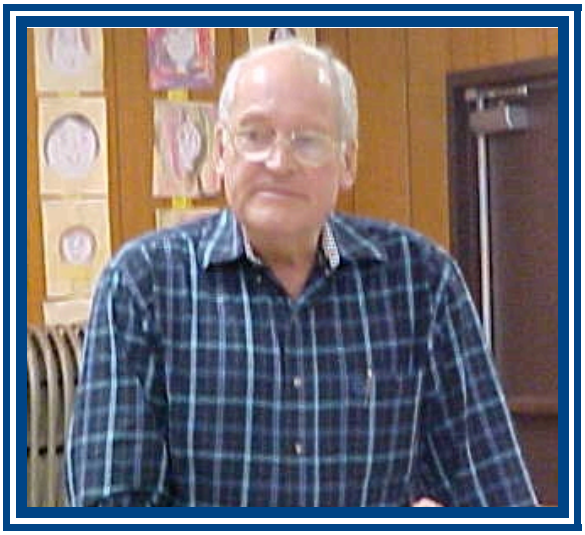
JAN 29-30 TSDA HOUSTON STAMP FAIR Bourse at the Holiday Inn Near the Galleria, 3131 West Loop Frwy (I-610 South at Richmond Ave exit), Houston, TX. Hours: Sat 10am-5pm, Sun 10am-4pm.

FEB 5-6 TSDA SAN ANTONIO STAMP FAIR Bourse at Norris Conference Center, 4522 Fredericksburg Rd (at Crossroads Mall near NW I-410 and I-10, next to Super- Target, lower level), San Antonio, TX. Hours: Sat 10am-5pm, Sun 10am-3pm.

FEB 25-26 TSDA DALLAS STAMP FAIR Bourse at the Richardson Civic Center, 411 W. Arapaho Rd. (next to Richardson City Hall), Richardson, Texas. Hours: Fri 11am-6pm, Sat 9am-4pm.

MAR 4-5 TX PRECANCEL CLUB SPRING ROUNDUP Spring auction & bourse of the Texas Precancel Club at the College Station Conference Center, 1300 George Bush Dr, College Station, TX. Hours: Fri 9am-10pm, Sat 8am-5pm. Auction on Sat at 2pm. Lunch provided to those who sign up before 10am each day. Contact: Katherine Foster, kh.foster@hotmail.com

LONE STAR CHAPTER of the Èire Philatelic Association International meets between 2:00pm and 4pm on the 2nd Saturday of every month in member's homes. Various aspects of Irish philately, and philately in general are discussed. All are welcome. For information call (210)658-9235.



Bill Downes

"China Treasures"
by Bill Downes
November 5, 2010

On November 5, 2010, our friend from across the ocean, Bill Downes, shared some of his China Treasures with us.

Bill comes from Canterbury and visits Texas periodically with his wife Mandy. He shares different "goodies" with us each time. Bill belongs to the China Society, ISB and FPHS in London.

Bill's wife, Mandy had a grandfather from Shanghai. He was a school teacher and a stamp collector. After Mandy's grandfather passed away, she and Bill fell heir to his very expansive China colletion.

Here are some of the most interesting items that Bill shared with us.

At right from the People's Republic is "The Commemoration of Chinese Relief Operation for The Disaster Stricken Countries in the Indian Ocean"—Earthquakes and Tsunamis.

He showed us a beautiful souvenier sheet of birds from Taiwan, pictured at left.

Nelda Greer

In fact, we were somewhat wary of being able to retrieve this bird sheet from Nelda's "Iron" grip: "Let go, Nelda, the rest of us want to see these treasures!!"

The pièce de resistance was a beautiful sheet, shown at left, from the People's Republic to mark the 50th anniversay of the founding of the People's Republic of China (56 ethnicities) There was a "sliding sheet" overlay to identify the individual ethnic groups.

Once again, Bill has "wowed" us. Thank you, Bill. We look forward to your next visit. I wonder what "treasures" you will share.

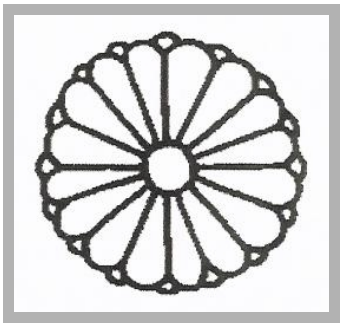
Yours in philately, Pat Richmond

"Lure of the Orient"
by John Clay
October 22, 2010

John Clay

On October 22, 2010, John Clay spoke to the club about forgeries on Japanese stamps. After WWII, Japan tried to "lure" philatelists to Japanese stamps by flooding the marketplace with forgeries.

John gave us some great advise on how to "weed-out" some of the fakes by ourselves before we have to pay an expensive expertizing fee.



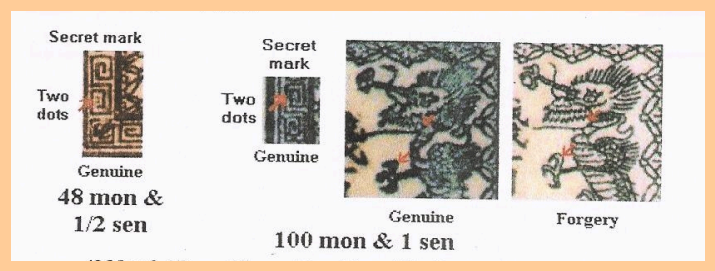
The first, most logical, hint John gave us was to look at the "cherry blossom" on the stamp. It should look like this (shown left):

If it doesn't have 16 petals, no more, no less, it's not a "rarity" folks—it's a fake!!!

Next make sure your stamp doesn't have an inscription that labels it as a fake (shown right).

In order to incorporate these inscriptions designating it as a "fake", the main designs were altered to make room for the inscription. Below is an example of some changes made in various denominations of the "dragon" series:

Other changes are shown below in the "cherry blossom" and "koban" series in different denominations in the handout that John gave us. If you are interested in persuing Japanese forgeries further, go to http://isjp.org/Expert/index.html .



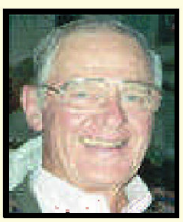
Aside from the above mentioned obvious items, other items can be considered. Sometimes the cancelations are smaller. Some of the paper after 1920 is different. Some of the airmail has a different paper that might be thinner and is on pure white paper.

John gave everyone enough to whet our appetites in Japanese collecting as well as many clues for diagnosing forgeries. The handout he gave to those who were present was "chock" full of more goodies.

Thanks, John for a most enjoyable and informative evening. We are looking forward to your next program in 2011.

Yours in philately, Pat Richmond

Closed Albums



1925-2010

Donald W. Becker

Two more members have been entered into our Closed Albums.

They are:

Donald W. Becker, SAPA #1875, 2015, who was a member of our club, off and on, since 1967.

&

James H. Black, SAPA # 2783, who joined our club in 2007.

1933-2010

James H. Black

They will be missed.

Dora Roberts, Lea Senghaas, Lillie Littrel, Richard Spies

Bob Joyce, Fred Groth, Bro. Ed Loch

Dr. Eric Shepherd, Harry Greer, Bob Joyce, Bro. Ed Loch, Nelda Greer, Dora Roberts

SAPA 2010

Pat Richmond, Rich & Marilyn Barnes, Reiko Clay, Lea Senghaas, Dora Roberts

Vernon Duncan, Delbert Richmond

Vernon Duncan, Lea Senghaas, Charles Shelby

Carolyn Virta

Christmas Party

Harry, Nelda & Arlen Greer

Orila & Barney Brandt, Vernon Duncan, Kurt Harding, Charles Shelby, Rose Marie & Bill McNally, Jack Virta, Fred Groth

Reiko & John Clay, Chip Swinney, Rich & Marilyn Barnes